

Electronics & Communication Systems

Digital Representations



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Agenda

- 1) Integer Representations
 - I. Unsigned
 - II. Signed
- 2) Real Representations
 - I. Floating-Point
 - II. Fixed-Point
- 3) Quantization Strategies in Digital Design
- 4) Bit-true implementation: Alpha-Max Beta-Min example

Agenda

1) Integer Representations

I. Unsigned

II. Signed

2) Real Representations

I. Floating-Point

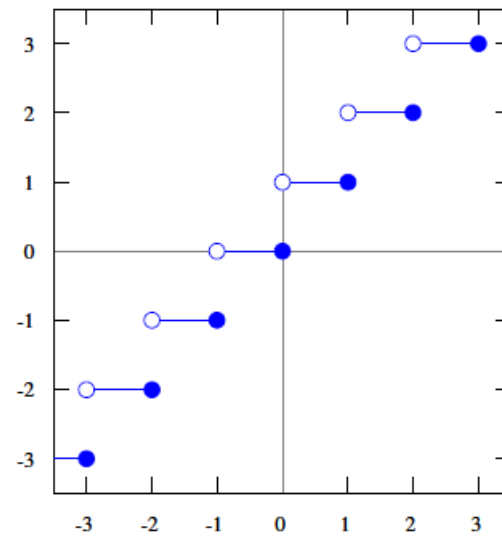
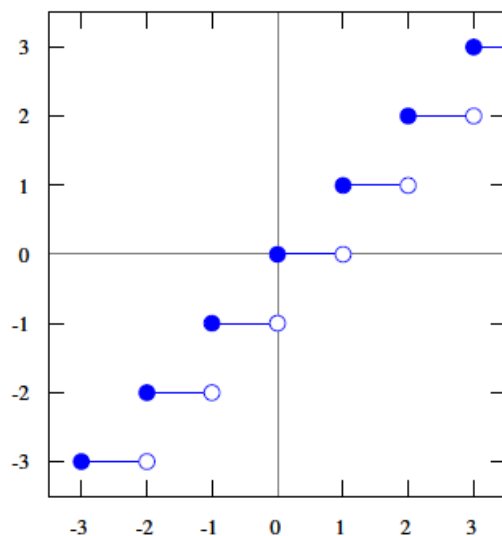
II. Fixed-Point

3) Quantization Strategies in Digital Design

4) Bit-true implementation: Alpha-Max Beta-Min example

Rounding $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$

- Greatest preceding integer $y = \lfloor x \rfloor = \text{floor}(x) = \max(y \in \mathbb{Z} : y \leq x)$
- Least succeeding integer $y = \lceil x \rceil = \text{ceil}(x) = \min(y \in \mathbb{Z} : y \geq x)$



Rounding $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$

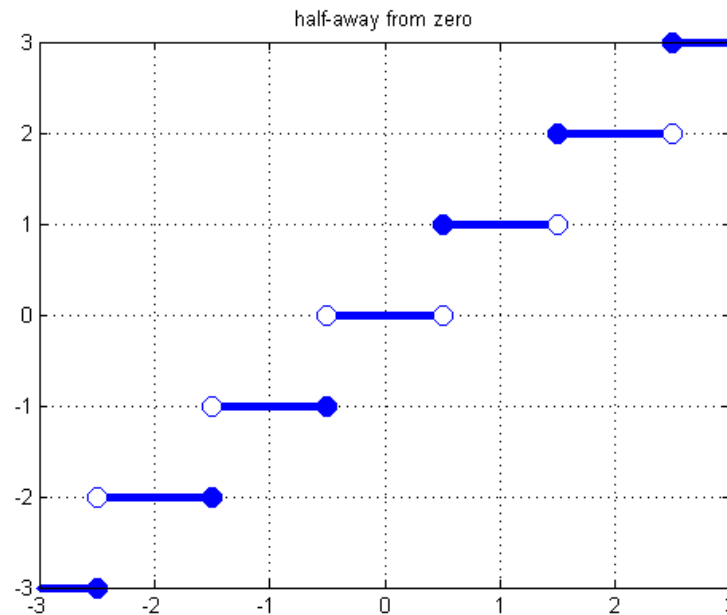
- Round half-up
- Round half-down
- **Round half-away**
- Round half-towards

$$y = \text{round}(x) = \lfloor x + 0,5 \rfloor$$

$$y = \text{round}(x) = \lceil x - 0,5 \rceil$$

$$y = \text{round}(x) = \text{sgn}(x) \lfloor |x| + 0,5 \rfloor$$

$$y = \text{round}(x) = \text{sgn}(x) \lceil |x| - 0,5 \rceil$$



Rounding $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$



`import math`



`#include <math.h>`



`y = floor(x)`

`y = ceil(x)`

`y = round(x)`

`y = fix(x)`

`y = math.floor(x)`

`y = math.ceil(x)`

`y = round(x)`

`y = int(x)`

`y = floor(x)`

`y = ceil(x)`

`y = round(x)`

`y = (int)x`

`=ARROTONDA.DIFETTO(A1;1)`

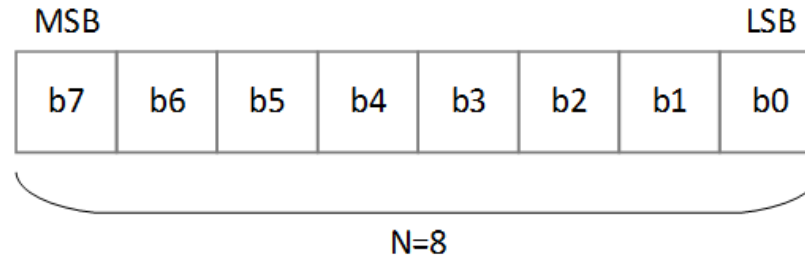
`=ARROTONDA.ECCESSO(A1;1)`

`=ARROTONDA(A1;0)`

`=ARROTONDA.PER.DIF(A1;0)`

Unsigned

- Given N -bit
- 2^N representations
- $UN(N) = [0: 2^N - 1]$



$$x = b_{N-1}b_{N-2} \dots b_1b_0 = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} b_k 2^k$$

$$N = \lceil \log_2(x + 1) \rceil$$

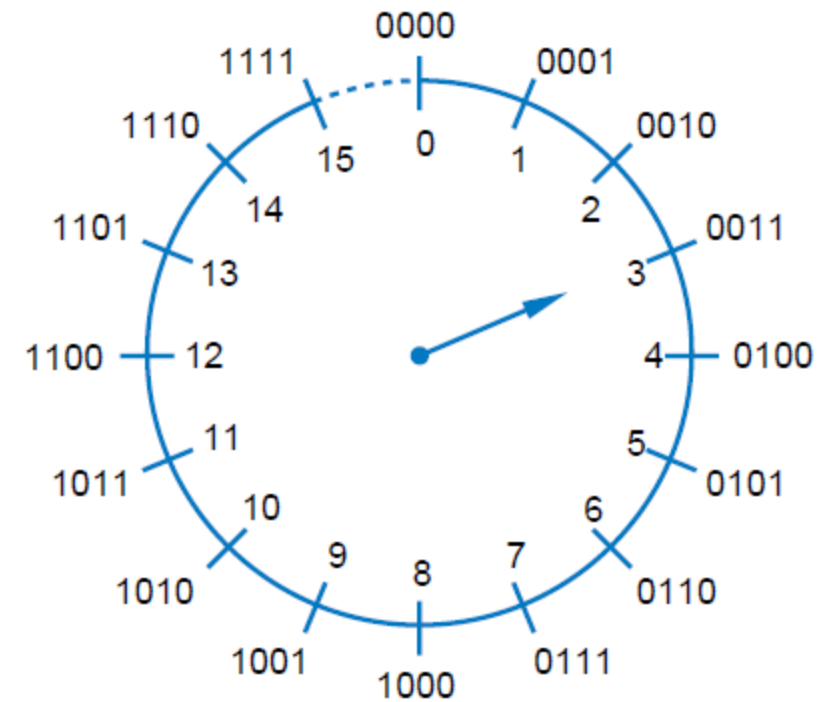
0000	0
0001	1
0010	2
0011	3
0100	4
0101	5
0110	6
0111	7
1000	8
1001	9
1010	10
1011	11
1100	12
1101	13
1110	14
1111	15

Unsigned

- Addition needs one bit more (MSB)
 - Avoid overflow or carry-out (wrap-around)
- $UN(N) + UN(N) \rightarrow UN(N + 1)$
- $UN(N) + UN(M) \rightarrow UN(\max(N, M) + 1)$

	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0
		1	1	1	1	0	1	1
1	0	0	1	0	1	1	0	1

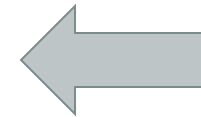
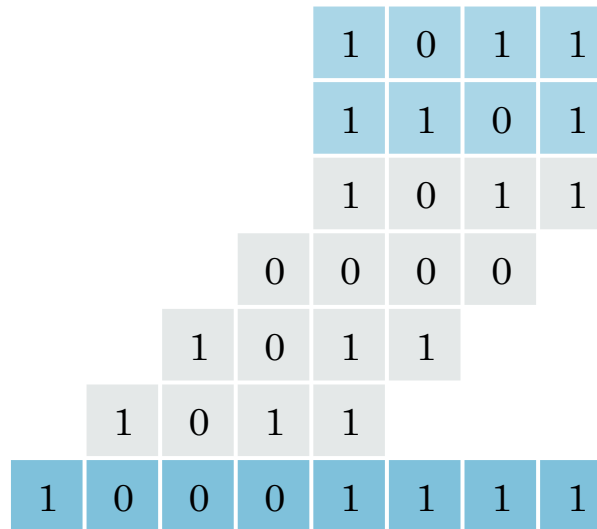
$$178 + 123 = 301$$



Unsigned

- Multiplication is representable on the sum of word length
- $UN(N) \times UN(N) \rightarrow UN(2N)$
- $UN(N) \times UN(M) \rightarrow UN(N + M)$

$$11 \times 13 = 143$$



Partial Products

Signed

- Sign and Magnitude
 - The MSB is the sign (0: positive, 1: negative)
 - Others are the magnitude

$$x = (-1)^{b_{N-1}} \times \sum_{k=0}^{N-2} b_k 2^k$$

- $N = 8$

b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0
$\pm$	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0

Signed

- Biased or Excess-K
 - The «all zero» representation is centered on $-K$
 - Representation as translation

$$x = -K + \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} b_k 2^k$$

- $N = 8$

b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0	
b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0	$-K$

Signed

- One's complement
 - Negative integers are bitwise negation of positives
 - Bitwise negation is the same of $2^N - 1 - |x|$

$$x = -b_{N-1}(2^N - 1) + \sum_{k=0}^{N-2} b_k 2^k$$

- $N = 8$

b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0
b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0

$$-b_7(2^7 - 1)$$

Signed

- Two's complement
 - Negative integers are bitwise negation of positives+1
 - right to left, until first '1', then flip the rest
 - Is the same of $2^N - |x|$

$$x = -b_{N-1}2^{N-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{N-2} b_k 2^k$$

- $N = 8$

b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0
b_7	b_6	b_5	b_4	b_3	b_2	b_1	b_0

 $-b_7 2^7$

Signed

- Two's complement (signed de facto)
- $SG(N) = [-2^{N-1}: 2^{N-1} - 1]$

$$N = \lceil \log_2(x + 1) \rceil + 1 \quad \text{if } x \geq 0$$

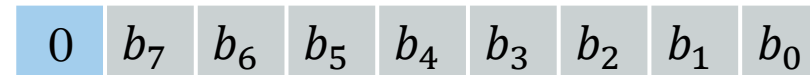
$$N = \lceil \log_2(|x|) \rceil + 1 \quad \text{if } x < 0$$

- C2 Balanced representation
- $SG_B(N) = [-2^{N-1} + 1: 2^{N-1} - 1]$

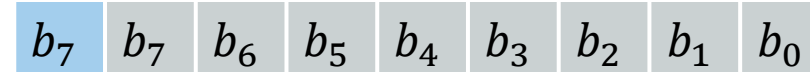
1000	-8
1001	-7
1010	-6
1011	-5
1100	-4
1101	-3
1110	-2
1111	-1
0000	0
0001	1
0010	2
0011	3
0100	4
0101	5
0110	6
0111	7

Word length extension

- Unsigned Extension
 - Insert '0' as new MSB



- Signed (C2) Extension
 - Copy the MSB as new MSB
 - From $x_{C2N+1} = |x|_{2^{N+1}}$



Addition

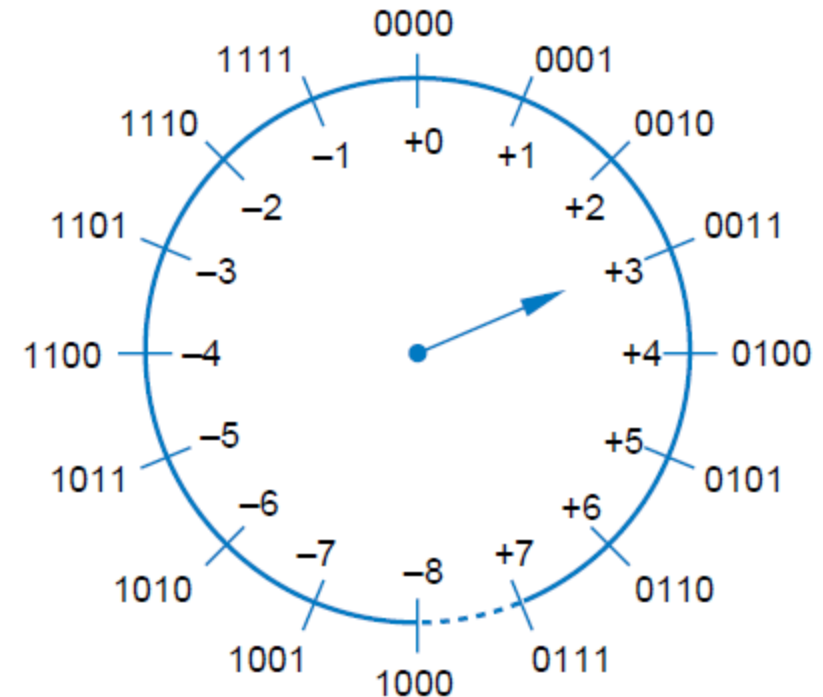
- Addition “needs” one bit more (MSB copied)
 - Avoid C2 overflow
 - Digital native $(x \pm y)_{C2} = |x_{C2} \pm y_{C2}|_{2^N}$
- $SG(N) + SG(N) \rightarrow SG(N + 1)$
- $SG(N) + SG(M) \rightarrow SG(\max(N, M) + 1)$

Extended

	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0
	0	0	1	1	1	1	0	1	1
1	0	0	0	1	0	1	1	0	1

$$-78 + 123 = 45$$

Don't mind the carry out in C2



Multiplication

- Multiplication is representable on the sum of word length
- $SG(N) \times SG(N) \rightarrow SG(2N)$ $SG_B(N) \times SG_B(N) \rightarrow SG_B(2N - 1)$
- $SG(N) \times SG(M) \rightarrow SG(N + M)$ $SG_B(N) \times SG_B(M) \rightarrow SG_B(N + M - 1)$



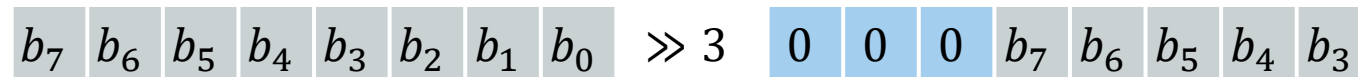
!!! Digital circuits **DO NOT** work intrinsically with C2 representation for multiplication !!!

- Absolute values multiplication (unsigned)
- Dedicated Architectures (Booth's algorithm, Baugh-Wooley multiplier...)

Shift Operation

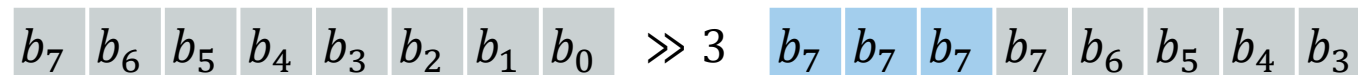
- Shift Right Logical (srl)

- Discard k bit from right and insert k zeros from left ($\left\lfloor \frac{x}{2^k} \right\rfloor$ on unsigned)



- Shift Right Arithmetical (sra)

- Discard k bit from right and insert k MSB from left ($\left\lfloor \frac{x}{2^k} \right\rfloor$ on signed)

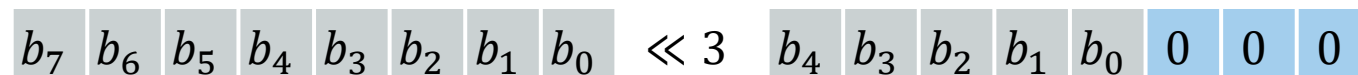


- Shift Left Logical (sll)

- Discard k bit from left and insert k zeros from right ($x \times 2^k$ on unsigned and signed)



- Overflow Possibilities!!



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Real Representations

Two models

- **Floating-Point**
- **Fixed-Point**

Properties

- **Precision:** Number of bit used.
- **Resolution:** Smallest positive number representable, zero excluded.
- **Range:** The set given by the minimum negative number and maximum positive number.
- **Accuracy:** Maximum error from the real number and its representation (usually = Resolution/2).
- **Dynamic Range:** Ratio of maximum positive over minimum positive, zero excluded (dB).

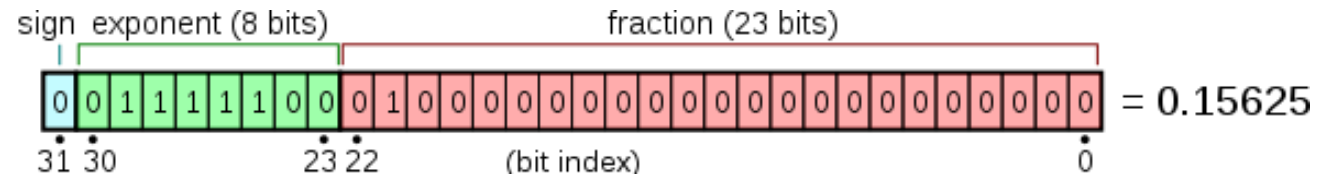
Floating-Point

$$x = M \times \beta^E$$

- M = Significand, signed fraction
- β = Base
- E = Exponent, signed integer
- “Normalized Form” $\rightarrow$ M representation with the MSDigit different from zero.

Floating-Point

- Standard IEEE 754
 - Single Precision (32 bit)
 - Double Precision (64 bit)



- M = Significand, 24 bit of magnitude +1 bit for sign
 - F = Fractional, 23 bit stored + 1 implicit, for normalized form 1.fff...
 - s = Sign bit
- β = Base 2
- E = Exponent, 8-bit integer with excess-127, biased (0 and 255 used for special cases)

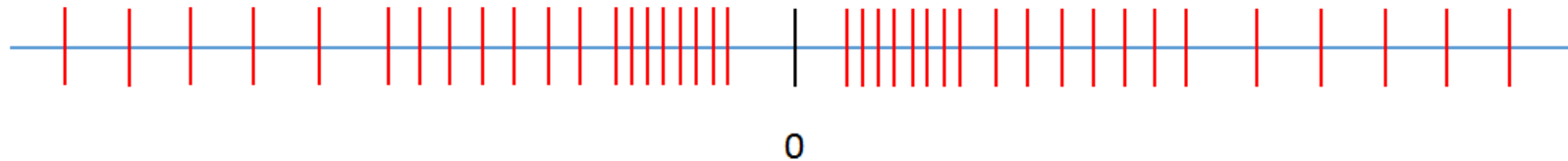
$$x = (-1)^s \times \left(1 + \sum_{k=1}^{23} b_{23-k} 2^{-k} \right) \times 2^{E-127}$$

Floating-Point

- Standard IEEE 754

	S	M	E	bias	~Min	~Max	DR	Max ϵ_r
Single	1 bit	1+23 bit	8 bit [-126:127]	127	10^{-38}	10^{+38}	1529 dB	$< 6 \times 10^{-8}$
Double	1 bit	1+51 bit	11 bit [-1022:1023]	1023	10^{-308}	10^{+308}	12312 dB	$< 3 \times 10^{-16}$

- Non-Uniform numbers distribution



Floating-Point

- Standard IEEE 754
 - Special cases

	$F = 0$	$F \neq 0$
$E = 0$	$(-1)^S \cdot 0$	$x = (-1)^S (0.F) 2^{-126}$
$E = 255$	$(-1)^S \cdot \infty$	NaN

± 0

denormalized $|x| < 2^{-127}$

$\pm \infty$

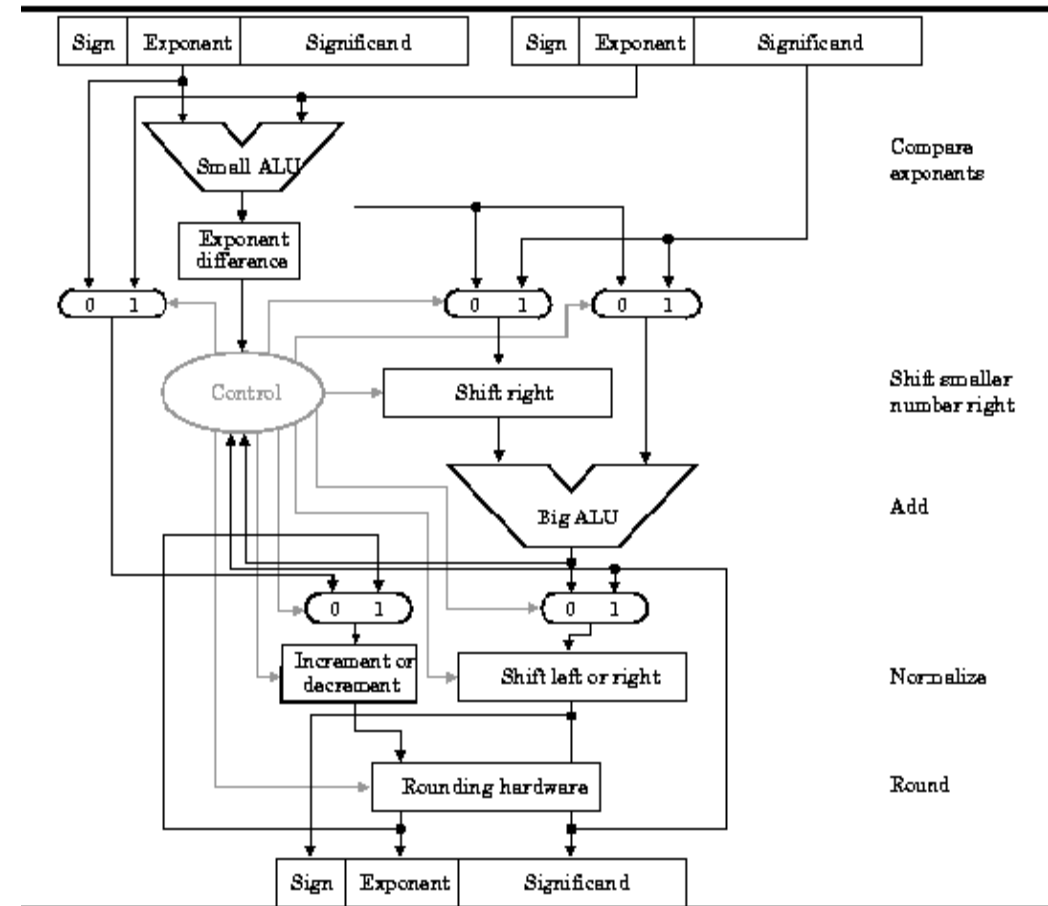
Not a Number (e.g. $\frac{0}{0}$)

Special cases must be managed with the same performance as normal cases.

Floating-Point

- Standard IEEE 754
- **Addition and Subtraction**
 - Align Fractional parts based on Exponents
 - Compute the result
 - Normalization and Round-off
 - Overflow possibility ($\pm\infty$)
 - Underflow possibility (denormalized)
- **Multiplication**
 - Add the exponents
 - Multiply Fractional
 - Normalization of result
 - XOR for sign bit

MIPS FPA for add, sub



Fixed-Point

- Represent less order of magnitude than the floating-point ranges. 
- But follow the integer arithmetic!! 

$$x = N \times \mathbf{LSB}_{value}$$

- If the $\mathbf{LSB}_{value}$ is a power of 2, we can effectively see the decimal point.

$$x = \underbrace{b_{M-1}b_{M-2} \dots \dots b_1b_0}_{integer\ part} \underbrace{b_{-1} \dots \dots b_{-(F-1)}b_{-F}}_{fractional\ part} = \sum_{k=-F}^{M-1} b_k 2^k$$

1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

●

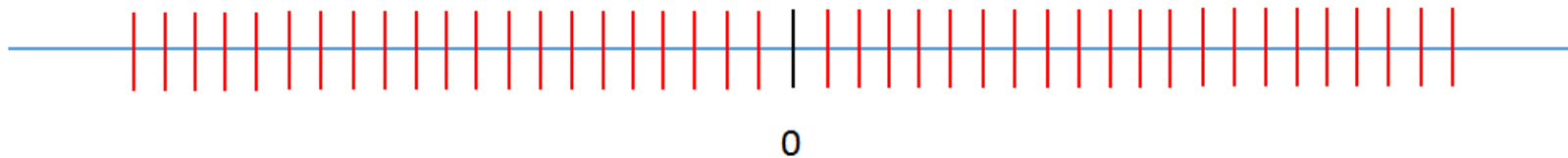
$$= 9.0625 = 145 \times 2^{-4}$$


- Fixed Point works exactly as integer representation but scaled by the weight of the LSB.

Fixed-Point

	Precision	Resolution	Accuracy	Range	DR
UN	8 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[0:255]	≈ 48 dB
SG	8 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[-128:127]	≈ 42 dB
UN	16 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[0:65535]	≈ 96 dB
SG	16 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[-32768:32767]	≈ 90 dB
UN	32 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[0:4294967295]	≈ 193 dB
SG	32 bit	LSB	LSB/2	[-2147483648:2147483647]	≈ 187 dB

- Uniform numbers distribution



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Quantization

$$x \rightarrow Q[x]$$

- $Q[x]$ is the quantization function.
- Should be one of the rounding (or floor) techniques showed.

$$Q[x] = \underbrace{\text{floor} \mid \text{round}}_{\text{Integer}} \left(\frac{x}{LSB} \right) \times LSB$$

- absolute error is $\epsilon_A = |Q[x] - x|$

Quantization

- How to select the LSB or the Precision for a signal, or a variable(s), representation?
- Two cases: **starts from the LSB** or reach the LSB.
- If the *LSB* is a power of 2 and a given ϵ_A is required (accuracy requirements)

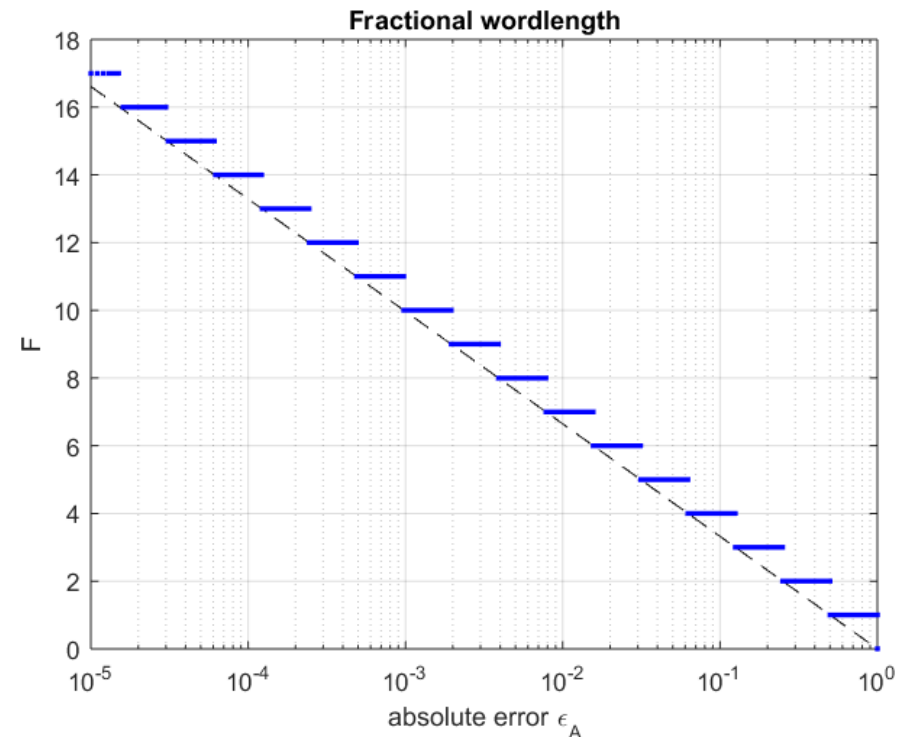
$$LSB = 2^{-F} \leq \epsilon_A \quad F = \left\lceil \log_2 \left(\frac{1}{\epsilon_A} \right) \right\rceil$$

Example

Represent $e = 2.718281828 \dots$ with $\max \epsilon_A = 10^{-3}$

$$F = \left\lceil \log_2 \left(\frac{1}{\epsilon_A} \right) \right\rceil = 10 \quad \rightarrow LSB = 2^{-10}$$

$$Q[e] = \left\lfloor \frac{e}{2^{-10}} \right\rfloor \times 2^{-10} = 2784 \times 2^{-10} = 2.71875$$



Quantization

- How to select the LSB or the Precision for a signal, or a variable(s), representation?
- Two cases: starts from the LSB or **reach the LSB**.
- If a range of reals has to be represented on N bits, we may normalize, remap, this range.

$$LSB = \frac{\max x}{2^{N-1} - 1} \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{|\min x|}{2^{N-1}}$$

Hp: $\max x > 0$;
 $\min x < 0$

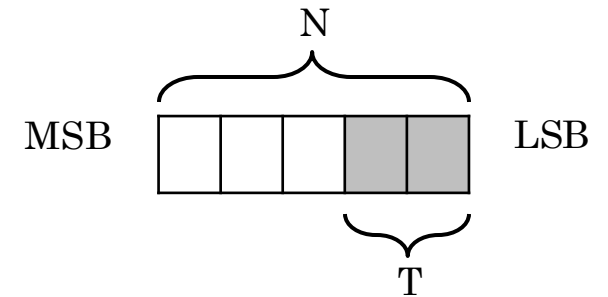
Example

Represent $[-\pi, \pi)$ on $N = 8$ bit $\rightarrow LSB = \frac{\pi}{2^{N-1}} = 0,024543692606 \dots$

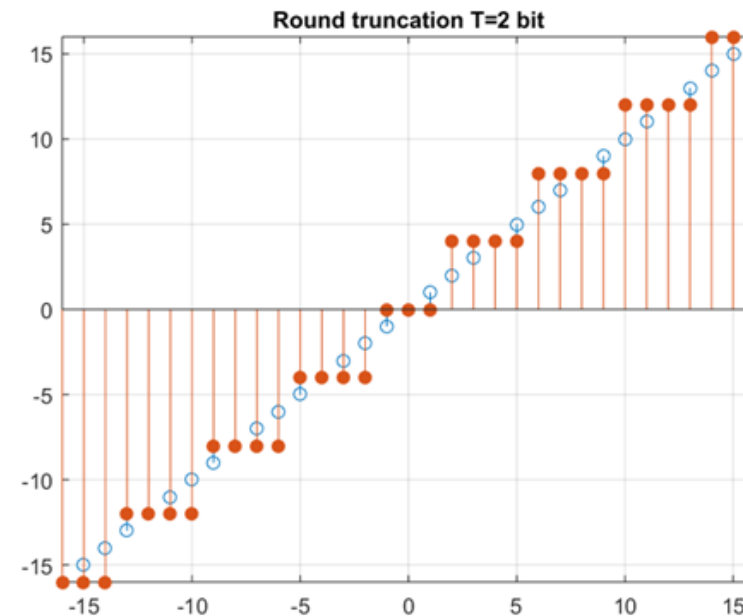
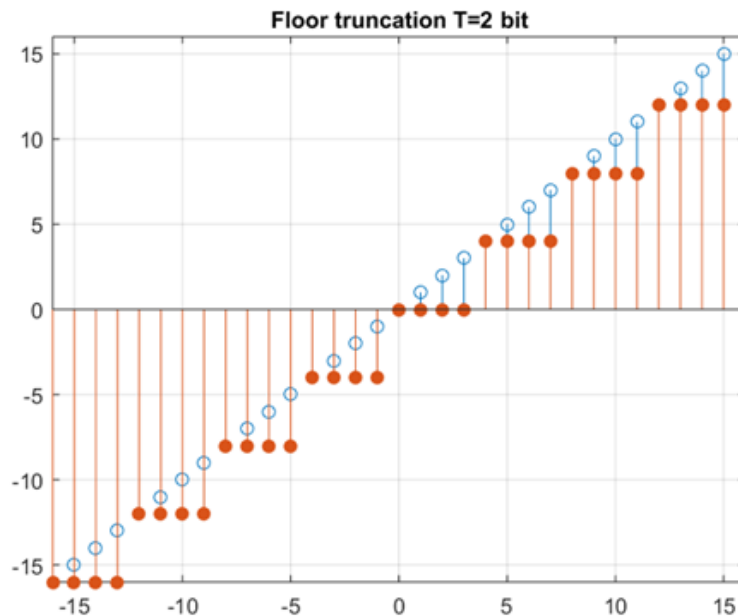
$$[-\pi, \pi) \rightarrow [-128:127] \times LSB$$

Quantization – Optimization

- **Truncation** discard T bit from right (LSBs).



- LSB changes value $LSB_{x_T} = LSB_x \cdot 2^T$
 - $x_T = floor\left(\frac{x}{2^T}\right)$ Simple, cut away T LSBs wires. Mean value altered.
 - $x_T = round\left(\frac{x}{2^T}\right)$ More Complex but does not alter the mean value.

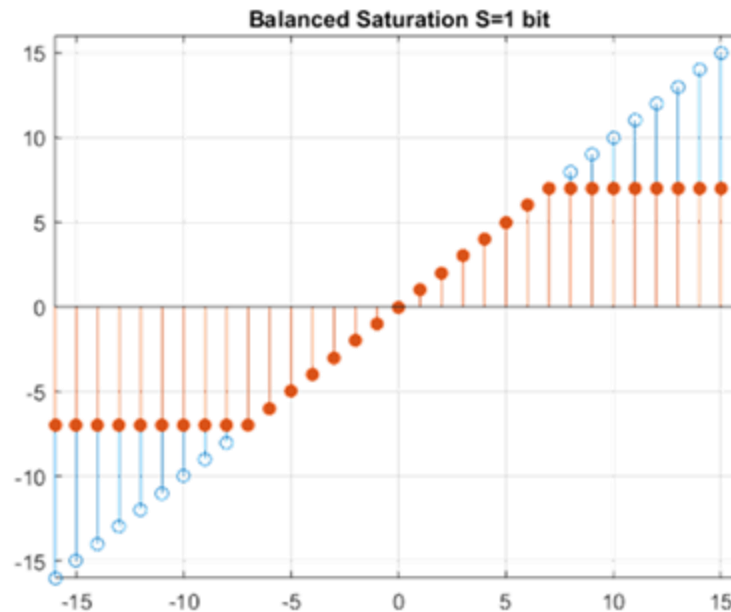
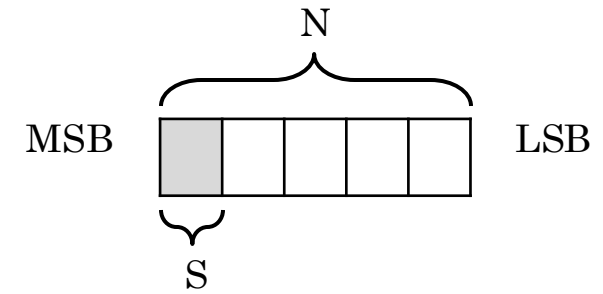


Quantization – Optimization

- **Saturation** discard S bit from left (MSBs) but implements a clipping strategies on data.

- LSB does not change value $LSB_{x_S} = LSB_x$

$$x_S = \begin{cases} x & x \in [-2^{N-S-1} + 1 : 2^{N-S-1} - 1] \\ -2^{N-S-1} + 1 & x < -2^{N-S-1} + 1 \\ 2^{N-S-1} - 1 & x > 2^{N-S-1} - 1 \end{cases}$$

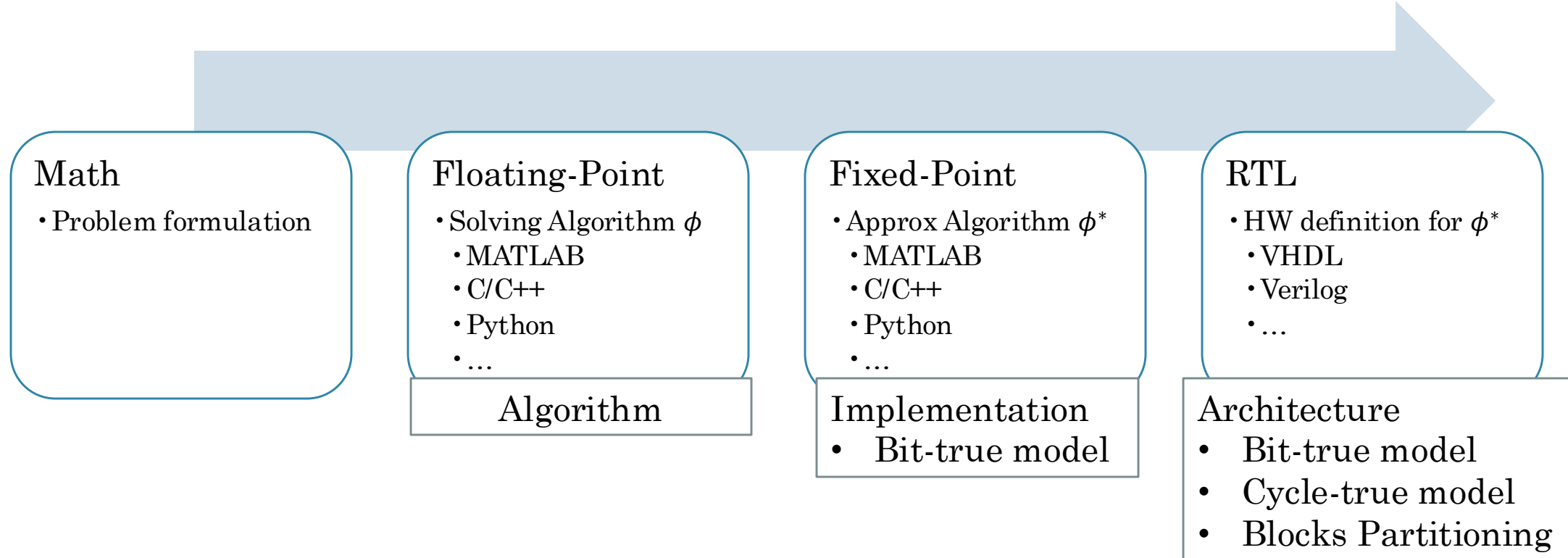


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Bit-true implementation

- Starting from a Problem “P” described by math formulation.
- The Design goes through many levels of abstraction to implement a digital circuit.



Alpha-max Beta-min

Math

Float

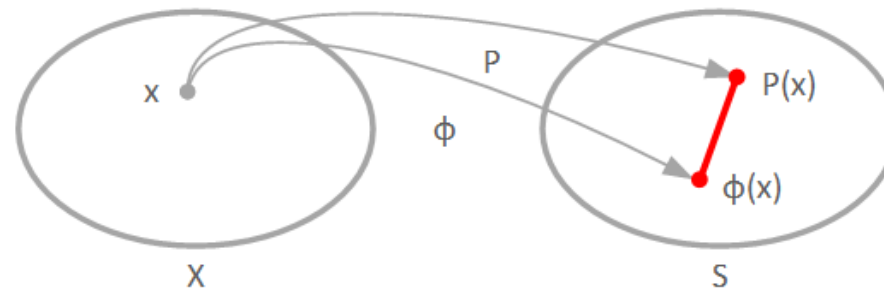
Fixed

RTL

- Compute the **magnitude of a complex number**
- Problem $P(a, b) = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$
- Square root operator is not easy in hardware, we need an approximated algorithm.

$$\phi(a, b) = \alpha \max(|a|, |b|) + \beta \min(|a|, |b|)$$

- Where α and β are real constant.



Alpha-max Beta-min

Math

Float

Fixed

RTL

- How to **measure the approximation of $\phi(a, b)$** vs the real problem $P(a, b)$?
- First, we have to select one metric to optimize (cost function). Common examples:
 - Maximum Error

$$MAX_E = \max_x (|\phi(x) - P(x)|)$$

- Mean Squared Error (MSE)

$$MSE = \frac{1}{card(X)^*} \sum_x (\phi(x) - P(x))^2$$

*cardinality/dimension of vector x

GOAL: Are there some α and β exact values that “minimize” a cost function?

Alpha-max Beta-min

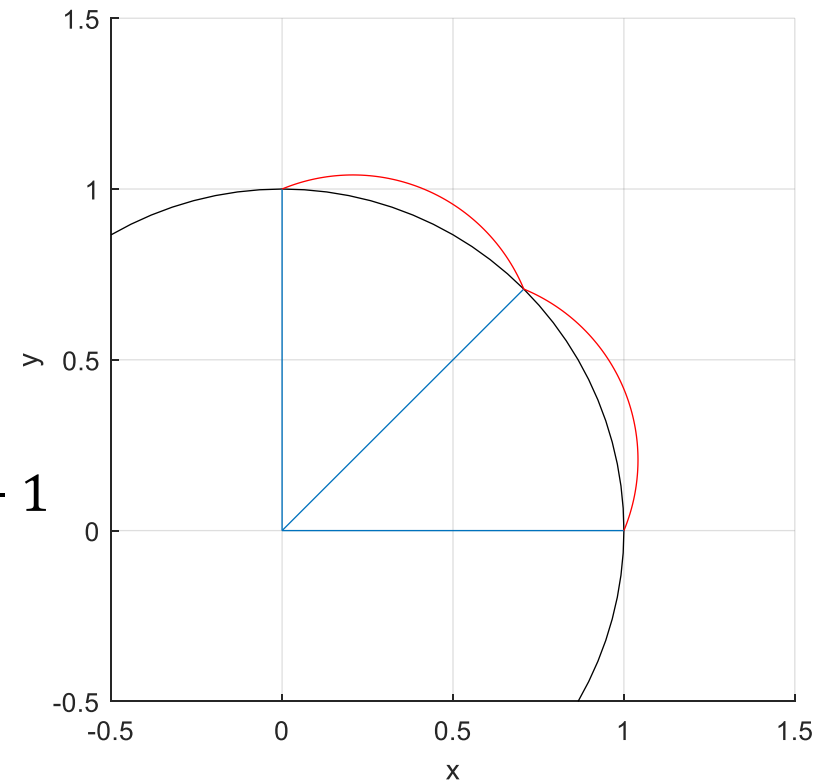
Math

Float

Fixed

RTL

- $\phi(x, y) = \alpha \max(|x|, |y|) + \beta \min(|x|, |y|)$
- Let's take points over the unitary radius for $0 \leq \theta \leq \frac{\pi}{4}$
 - $\phi(\theta) = \alpha \cos(\theta) + \beta \sin(\theta)$ for $0 \leq \theta \leq \frac{\pi}{4}$
- For $\theta = 0$ we hit $\phi = \alpha$
- For $\theta = \frac{\pi}{4}$ we hit, symmetrically, $\phi = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}(\alpha + \beta)$
- First empirical closed form $\alpha = 1$ then $\beta = \sqrt{2} - 1$



Alpha-max Beta-min

Math

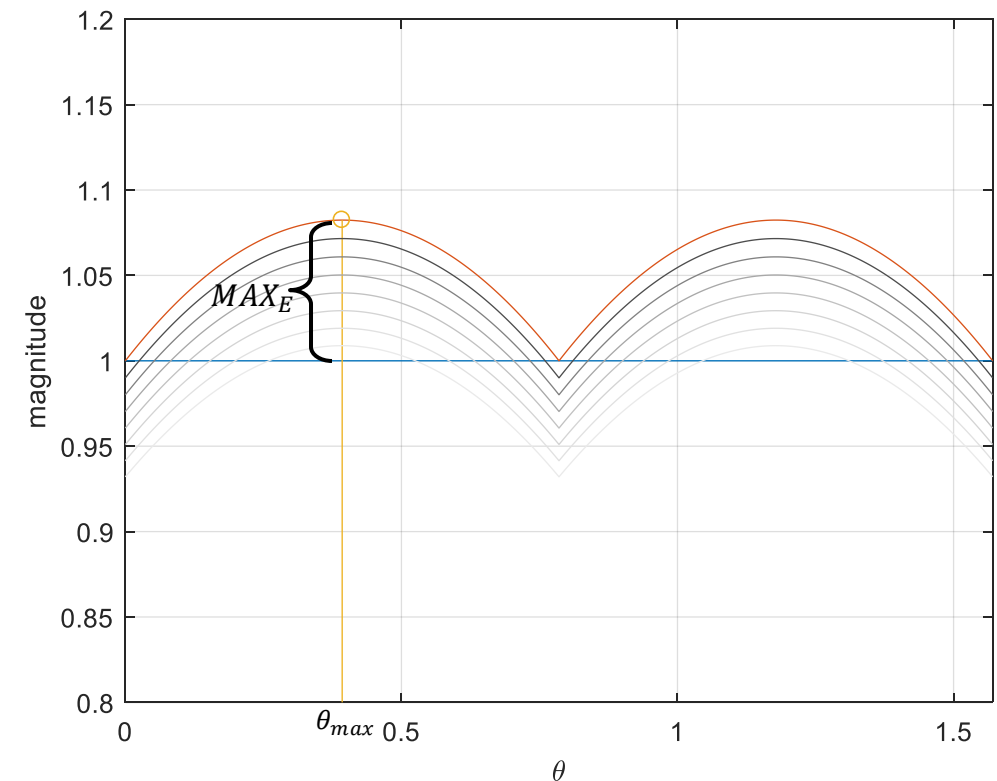
Float

Fixed

RTL

- $\phi(x, y) = \alpha \max(|x|, |y|) + \beta \min(|x|, |y|)$
- If $\alpha = 1$ $\beta = \sqrt{2} - 1$ the max error is on $\theta_{max} = \text{atan} \frac{\beta}{\alpha} = \frac{\pi}{8}$
 $MAX_E \approx 0.0824$ (8.24%)
- We can reduce α, β and balance the errors
- $E(\theta) = |\alpha \cos(\theta) + \beta \sin(\theta) - 1|$
 - $E(0) = 1 - \alpha$
 - $E\left(\frac{\pi}{8}\right) = \alpha \cos \frac{\pi}{8} + \beta \cos \frac{\pi}{8} - 1$
 - $E\left(\frac{\pi}{4}\right) = 1 - \alpha \cos \frac{\pi}{4} - \beta \cos \frac{\pi}{4}$
- We want to find α, β so that:

$$\begin{cases} E\left(\frac{\pi}{8}\right) = E(0) \\ E\left(\frac{\pi}{4}\right) = E(0) \end{cases}$$



Alpha-max Beta-min

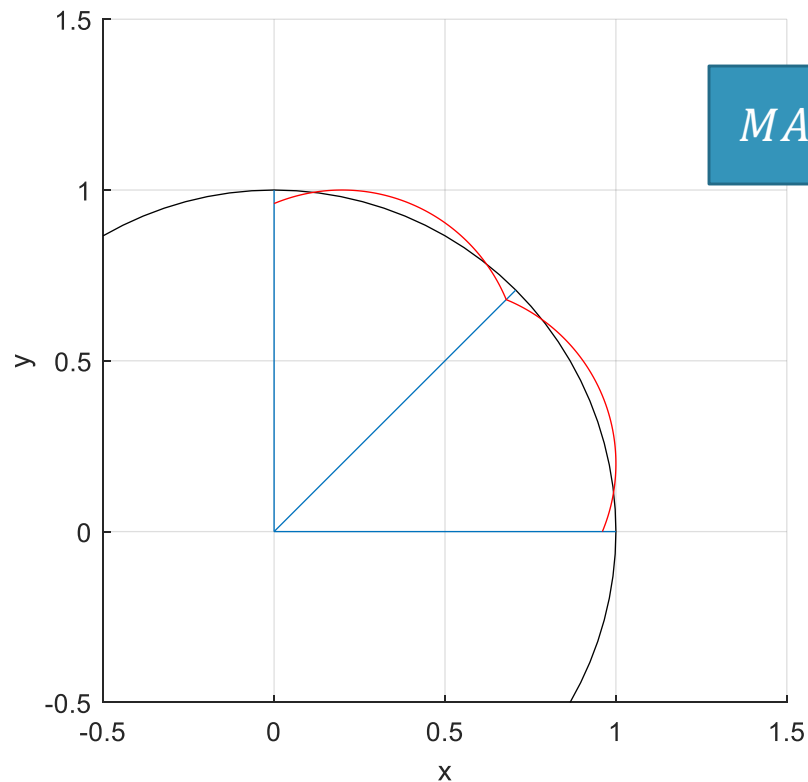
Math

Float

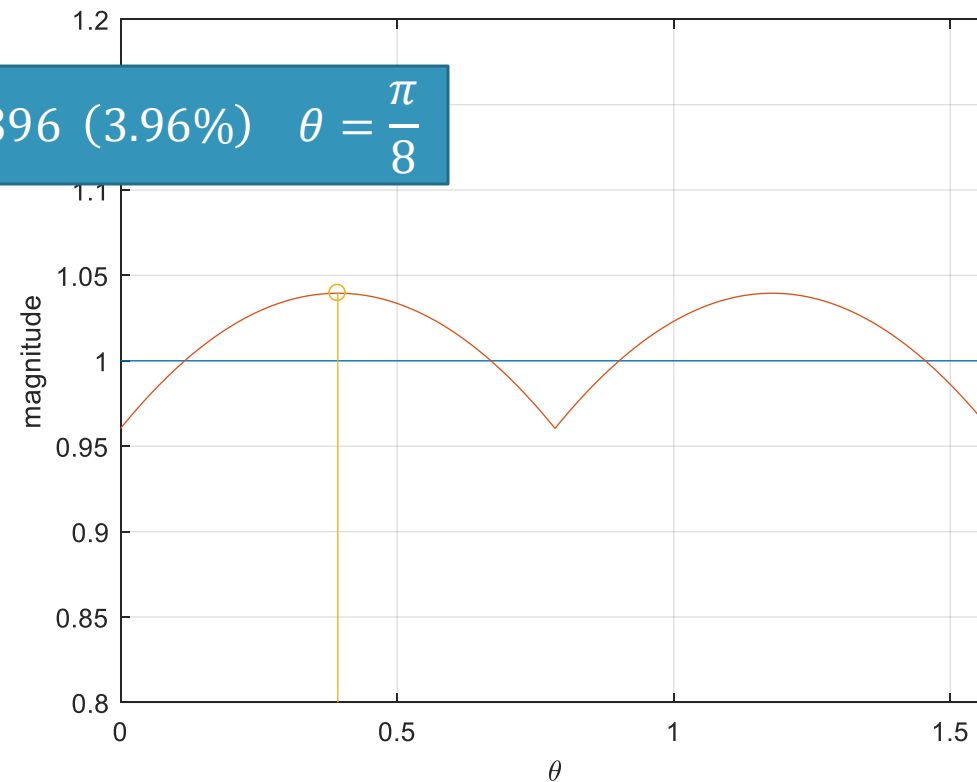
Fixed

RTL

$$\alpha = \frac{2 \cos \frac{\pi}{8}}{1 + \cos \frac{\pi}{8}} \approx 0.96043 \dots \quad \beta = \frac{2 \sin \frac{\pi}{8}}{1 + \cos \frac{\pi}{8}} \approx 0.39782 \dots$$



$$MAX_E \approx 0.0396 \text{ (3.96\%)} \quad \theta = \frac{\pi}{8}$$



Alpha-max Beta-min

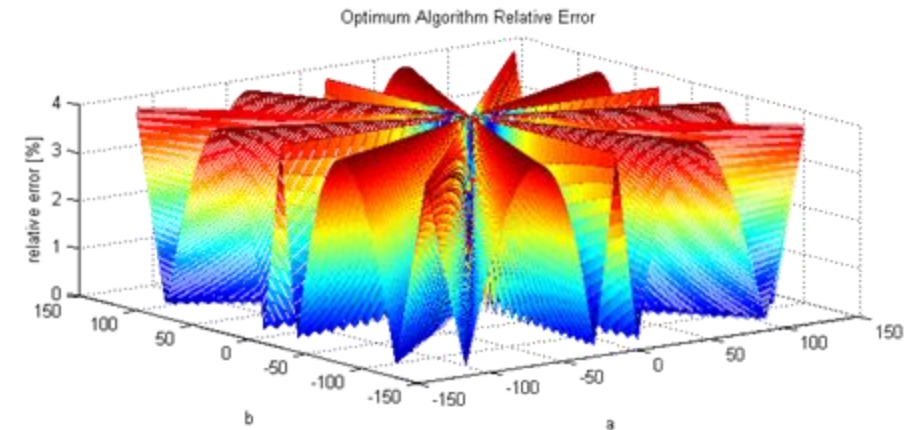
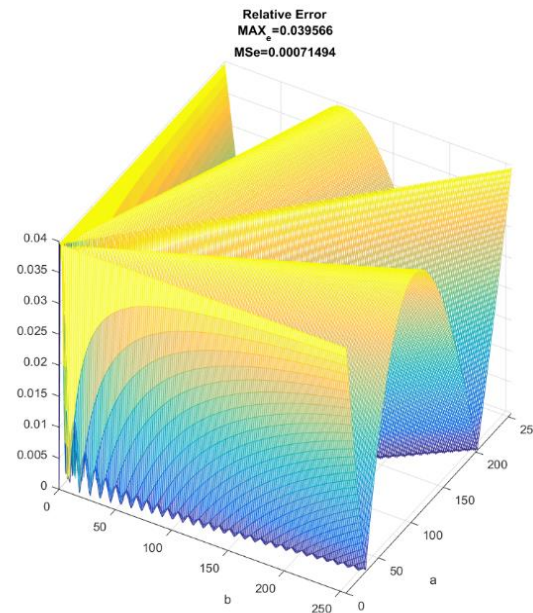
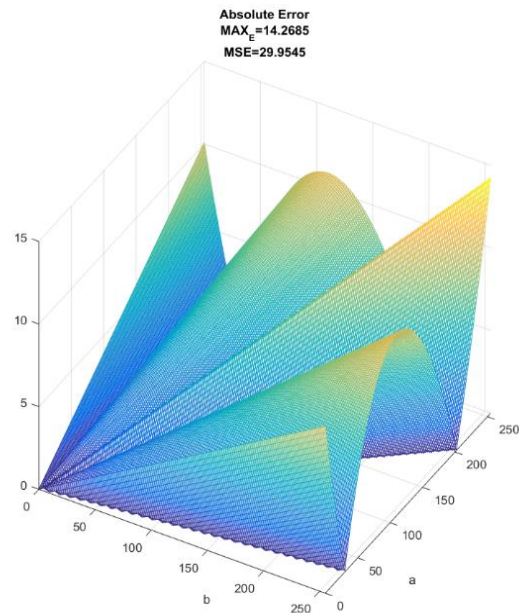
Math

Float

Fixed

RTL

- However, we can write a floating-point model
- Find the optimum (min) of a cost function on 2D space with numerical computations.



Alpha-max Beta-min

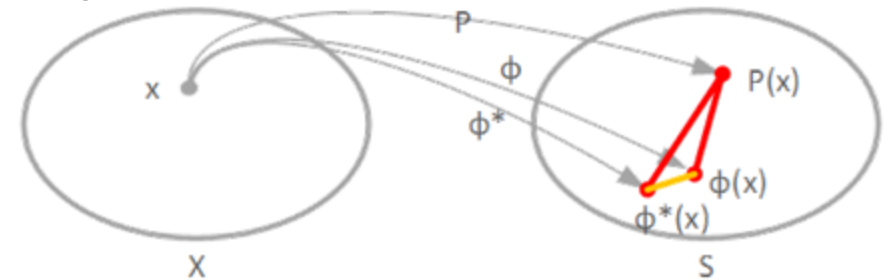
Math

Float

Fixed

RTL

- To achieve bit-true model we have to quantize α, β
- $Q[\alpha] = \text{round}\left(\frac{\alpha}{2^{-F}}\right) \times 2^{-F}$
- $Q[\beta] = \text{round}\left(\frac{\beta}{2^{-F}}\right) \times 2^{-F}$



F = 1	alpha = 2/2	beta = 1/2	error = 11.8034%
F = 2	alpha = 4/4	beta = 2/4	error = 11.8034%
F = 3	alpha = 8/8	beta = 3/8	error = 6.8%
F = 4	alpha = 15/16	beta = 6/16	error = 7.1891%
F = 5	alpha = 31/32	beta = 13/32	error = 5.0484%
F = 6	alpha = 61/64	beta = 25/64	error = 4.9794%
F = 7	alpha = 123/128	beta = 51/128	error = 4.0266%
F = 8	alpha = 246/256	beta = 102/256	error = 4.0266%

Alpha-max Beta-min

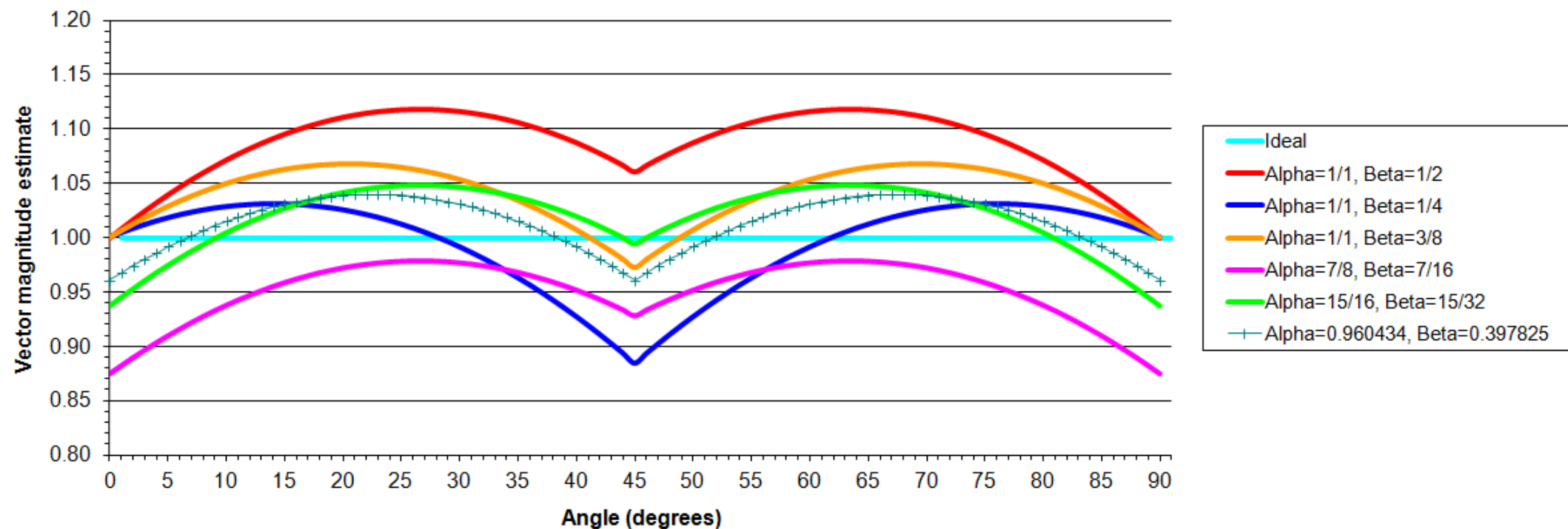
Math

Float

Fixed

RTL

Alpha Max plus Beta Min results for various values of Alpha and Beta



End

- 1) Integer Representations
 - I. Unsigned
 - II. Signed
- 2) Real Representations
 - I. Floating-Point
 - II. Fixed-Point
- 3) Quantization Strategies in Digital Design
- 4) Bit-true implementation:
Alpha-Max Beta-Min example

